

# **SNIFF Test for AI-generated Content**

**NOTE:** Depending on the info and how you plan to use it, you may not use *all* the SNIFF Test strategies *all* the time. But you should keep these in mind when encountering unfamiliar, or potentially, AI-generated info.

## **SOURCE CHECK!**

Don't rely on a single piece of information from AI. It makes stuff up. Verify the source/claim by looking at trusted, reputable sources like well-known news outlets, academic publications, or official websites.

## **NAVIGATE to a **NEW TAB****

To evaluate a suspicious source/claim, navigate to a new tab and Google it. Find a source that confirms or refutes it. This strategy of verifying info as you're reading it is called, '[lateral reading](#),' and is critical for evaluating sources online. For images, try a reverse Google image search, or [TinEye](#).

## **INVESTIGATE CITATIONS**

If the AI output provides specific references or citations, look them up yourself to confirm they exist. You can plug the article title with quotes ("" ) into your library's search engine or Google. If you can't find it quickly, it's likely an [AI hallucination](#). You also want to verify that the citation actually supports the info presented. Just because it's cited, doesn't mean it's accurate.

## **FACT-CHECK EVERYTHING**

Websites like Snopes, FactCheck.org, or PolitiFact can help verify claims that sound suspicious or widely debated on social media. Sometimes AI-generated info mixes up dates, statistics, or names. Double-check such details carefully. When in doubt, ask a human - professor, librarian, or someone who is knowledgeable on the topic.

## **FIGHT the **URGE** to **COPY+PASTE!****

AI tools are known to present people with fictitious information *confidently*. Even if it sounds plausible and you're short on time, don't just copy and paste the information into your work. Use the strategies above to verify the info for accuracy.

